



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Kazakhstan. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.
What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing your background! It's great that you're thinking about your future early. In Denmark, there are several strong educational paths after primary school, and the best choice depends on your interests, strengths, and career goals. Here's a clear overview of your main options:

1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

These are academically focused and prepare you for university. Good if you enjoy school subjects and want to keep your options open.

- **STX (Studentereksamen)** – Broadest academic program, with focus on science, languages, social studies, or arts.
- **HHX (Higher Commercial Exam)** – Focus on business, economics, and international trade.
- **HTX (Higher Technical Exam)** – Focus on technology, science, IT, and innovation.
- **HF (Higher Preparatory Exam)** – Shorter (2 years), more practical/academic mix, good if you're unsure or want faster access to specific higher education.

● **Recommended if:** You enjoy academic work, may want to go to university, and want to keep doors open.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training – EUD)

These are more hands-on and lead to a skilled job. You often alternate between school and work (apprenticeship).

- Fields include: carpentry, electrician, hairdressing, IT-support, mechanic, cooking, health care assistant, etc.
- Often leads to good job opportunities or can lead to **EUX**, a mix that also gives access to higher education.

● **Recommended if:** You want a practical job, like working with your hands, and want to enter the job market earlier.

3. EUX – Vocational + Academic Hybrid

Combines vocational education **with** general upper secondary subjects.

- More demanding, but gives you both a trade qualification and access to university.

- Example: You can become a carpenter **and** qualify for engineering studies.

 **Recommended if:** You like hands-on work but also want the option of further education.

Tips for Choosing:

- **Explore your interests:** What subjects do you enjoy? Math? Science? Languages? Creative arts? Business?
 - **Think about your learning style:** Do you prefer theory or practical work?
 - **Visit open house events (Åbent Hus)** at schools – very common in Denmark.
 - **Talk to a UU-vejleder (Youth Guidance Counselor)** – they can help you explore options based on your skills and goals.
-

Bonus: Your Cultural Background

Being from a Kazakh background and fluent in Danish is a **huge strength**. You may have cultural understanding, language skills, and an international mindset that can be a big advantage in fields like:

- International business (HHX)
 - Languages or social sciences (STX)
 - Tech and global innovation (HTX)
 - Tourism, translation, or diplomacy later on
-

Final Thought:

If you're unsure, **STX or HF** gives the most flexibility. But if you know you like something specific (like cooking, mechanics, or programming), starting a vocational track (maybe EUX) can get you further, faster.

Would you like help making a pros and cons list based on your interests or strengths? Or I can help you find local schools/programs in your area.